

Free, Prior and Informed Consent — Template

Reference English version · the holder signs the Shona or Ndebele version

How this template is used

Consent is taken in the holder's own language, in person, by a trained community liaison, and only after the community council has endorsed the interview. The English text below is the reference version; the holder signs the Shona or Ndebele version. A consent recorded in a language the holder does not speak is not consent, and `consent_language` is a required field so that this is auditable.

The date is not a formality. The schema enforces **CHECK (`consent_date` <= `interview_date`)**: a record whose consent is dated after the interview cannot be written to the database. The 'prior' in prior informed consent is a constraint, not an intention.

Part 1 · What is being asked

We are recording knowledge about plants and their uses, so that scientists in Zimbabwe can study the chemistry of those plants. We would like to write down what you tell us, and, if you agree separately, to record your voice.

We may collect a physical sample of the plant you describe. That sample will be sequenced and chemically analysed. The record of what you told us stays linked to that sample, permanently, by a reference number.

Part 2 · What you decide

Decision	Your choice
May we write down what you tell us?	Yes / No
May we record your voice? (separate from the above — you may agree to one and refuse the other)	Yes / No
How should this knowledge be classified?	Public / Community-restricted (Sacred knowledge is not requested and will not be recorded. If what you wish to share is sacred, please do not share it with us.)
Do you wish to be named as a contributor in publications, or credited through your community only?	Name me / Community only
Do you understand you may withdraw at any time, for any reason, with no consequence?	Yes / No

Part 3 · What you are promised

You may stop at any time. Withdrawal is permanent and unconditional, and you do not have to give a reason. Within 30 days everything linked to your record is removed or de-linked. You do not need to find the same person to withdraw; any community liaison or the community council can pass on your request.

If money is ever made, you share in it. A benefit-sharing agreement is signed before we record anything, not afterwards. Your record number stays attached to any compound found in the plant you described, for as long as that compound is studied. That link is held in the structure of the database itself, so it cannot be quietly lost.

Your name is not in the dataset. Your record carries a reference code. The list connecting codes to people is encrypted, held by SIRDC, and never shared with any researcher, at any level of access, inside or outside Zimbabwe.

Your community decides on restricted knowledge. If you classify your knowledge community-restricted, no one sees it without both SIRDC and your community council agreeing.

Part 4 · Record

Consent reference	FPIC-ZW-YYYY-CNNN
Holder pseudonym issued	HLD-__-__
Language of this consent	Shona (sn) / Ndebele (nd) / English (en)
Format	Signature / witnessed thumbprint
Date of consent	_____ (must not be later than the interview date)
Community council endorsement reference	END-CC__-YYYY-__
Benefit-sharing agreement reference	BSA-ZW-YYYY-NNN (signed before collection)
Community liaison	LIA-__-__
Witness	_____

Every field above is logged in governance/consent_log.csv, and the validator checks each heritage record against that log on every ingest. A record that disagrees with the consent log is a critical failure and holds the batch.

Miti AI Consortium · POTRAZ AI for Impact Challenge 2026 · Track 1: Data · Lead Innovator: Mutsa M Mutepfa · ZW-BioBank v1.0.0